

Myco – Mysteries Capsule Machine



Fig. 1. Image of the capsule machine.

This is a fungi-themed capsule machine which visitors can interact with. By turning the central cylinder at the front of the box, visitors are able to roll out a capsule or container that contains a small model of a specific fungal species that is accompanied by an information slip. Although, the mechanism itself is admittedly clunky. The exterior of the capsule machine is decorated with fungi-relevant items as well. This includes saprotrophic fungi that grows on decaying logs, rack of commercially grown mushrooms and leaves with yellow and brown spots that indicate chlorosis and necrosis.

The models are made with air-dry clay and paper to highlight characteristic features that the fungus has. They are also painted to the best of my abilities with similar colors as captured in online sources. Each information slip includes information regarding the fungus's scientific classification, common names, uses by humans, characteristic features as well as a real-life picture to complement the simplified clay model. There is also a QR code at the rightmost bottom corner of each slip for visitors to access the references used for the information on the slips. There are 10 containers in total where there are 2 duplicates of 5 distinct species. Namely, the species are *Amanita muscaria*, *Cookeina tricholoma*, *Cyathus striatus*, *Sphaerobolus stellatus*, *Xylaria polymorpha*.

Ultimately, this capsule machine intends to spark the visitor's interest in fungi by introducing a selected few fungal species that have memorable features in an interactive manner. This creation intends to educate others regarding the 5 fungal species and facilitate appreciation for the importance of fungi through information on how humans utilize the fungi. Additionally, the interactive element of the machine aims to facilitate

greater engagement with the visitor and leave a lasting impression which also helps he visitors retain the knowledge they learned from the creation.

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